

Reading Journal IX - SEIII

For the remaining Reading Journals there will be three different options, or "tracks". Remember that you **only have to choose one track**. Your options are:

1. **Track One: Extensive Reading - Fiction.** Please choose a new work of fiction. It could be a novel OR a series of short stories. The novel can be any genre (adventure, mystery, historical fiction, romance, sci-fi, classic literature, etc. Obviously, your choice(s) must be in English.
2. **Track Two: Extensive Reading - Non-Fiction.** Please choose work of non-fiction. It could be a book OR a series of academic articles. The book can be about any subject (history, science, geography, philosophy, etc.) Obviously, your choice(s) must be in English.
3. **Track Three - Textbook.** You can also choose to complete readings from our textbook. These should be readings we HAVE NOT done in class. Narrow down the list to four text passages.
Please write a **REFLECTION** about what you read. Include a brief summary of the main points along with your thoughts/observations/feelings. What did you learn? What was interesting about this reading? (150 words)
Choose **ONE** of these three tracks and complete the required questions. Due Sunday, December 14th by 21:00.

Track II

- **Title:** Being Logical: A Guide to Good Thinking
- **Author:** D. Q. McInerny
- **Reflection:**

The book says we should separate what's relevant from what's just pressure. An appeal to pity asks for sympathy instead of reasons, like "Please pass my examination, since I worked all night." Effort is not evidence. An appeal to force uses a threat: "Support the proposal if you care about your job." Both can silence people, but neither of them showcases what is true. Currently I always use a simple evidence test in emails and meetings, which is, delete the emotional or coercive line and see what still connects the premise to the conclusion. Therefore, the strongest point wasn't a video or an "inspiration" story in a speech or presentation. This isn't to ban emotion—stories can help—but each story should pass the baton to evidence. Relevance gives an argument a base, and loudness is only noise.